Value Stream Map Canvas (DP Section 4)

> **Day 4 · Activities 1–4 handout.** The one-page canvas for mapping your feature's delivery stream: steps, process time, lead time, queues, and total flow efficiency.

Draw this on a whiteboard or large paper. The visual makes the queues hit emotionally. Aim for **7–10 steps** (more = over-decomposed; fewer = lumping).

The canvas

```
[Step 1]──→[Step 2]──→[Step 3]──→...
   |           |           |
   PT: __      PT: __      PT: __
   LT: __      LT: __      LT: __

   QUEUE       QUEUE       QUEUE
   __ items    __ items    __ items
   __ days     __ days     __ days

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Total cycle time: __ days
Total process time: __ days
Total flow efficiency: __%
```

Per-step worksheet

Fill one row per step. Use real data where available (ADO data; team retros). Otherwise estimate honestly — and label it an estimate.

Step	What happens	Owner (role)	PT	LT	Flow eff (PT/LT)	Notes

Worked sample — FieldPulse reconcile

Step	PT	LT	Flow eff	Notes
Idea	1 hour (signal review)	3 days (queue at TPM's calendar)	5%	Signal sometimes lost in inbox
Discovery	4 hours	2 days	25%	Often blocked on customer-interview scheduling
Spec	16 hours	2 weeks	22%	Multiple stakeholder review cycles
Estimate + accept	1 hour	1 week (queue for sprint planning)	3%	One sprint planning per 2 weeks
Build	8 hours per story	1 week per story (mid-sprint)	14%	Multi-tasking; dependency wait
Code review	30 min review	1.5 days waiting for reviewer	4%	Reviewer queue
QA + integration	4 hours	2 days	12%	QA staffing constraint
Deploy	30 min ship	6 hours (deploy windows)	8%	Daily deploy schedule
Measure	1 hour per check	30 days for outcome	n/a	Inherent waiting (data accrual)

Total cycle time idea-to-deploy: ~6–8 weeks. Total flow efficiency for the whole stream: typically **5–15%**.

Optional: AI critique of your VSM

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Role: Lean coach reviewing a software value stream.
Context: <description of the VSM with PT/LT/flow eff numbers
         and identified queues>
Task: Identify 3 queues likely missing or under-counted:
  1. A queue between two steps not yet shown
  2. A step where PT and LT seem out of line with team reality
  3. An invisible queue (e.g., approvals, "ping someone")
Constraints:
  - Use only the data given
  - Be specific
Format: 3 numbered findings — what's missing / why suspect / how to
verify.
```

What "good" looks like

- Numbers are **honest**, even if estimated (and estimates are flagged as estimates).
- Flow efficiency is **computed** (a single-digit number is typical and informative).
- Distinguish a **systemic queue** (waste) from a **necessary delay** (e.g., 30 days for outcome data is not a bug).